

BRIOCHE BURGER BUNS



YIELD	ACTIVE TIME	REST	OVEN
6 buns	5 h including rises	1-1.5 h first rise, then 1-2 h after shaping	375F / 190C, 16-18 min
UNIT WEIGHT		ENERGY COST	
95-105 g each		\$1.65 (18 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)	

INGREDIENTS

60 g	Whole milk, for the tangzhong
27 g	Water, for the tangzhong
20 g	Bread flour, for the tangzhong
120 g	Whole milk
9 g	Instant yeast
320 g, plus more for the bench	Bread flour
35 g	Granulated sugar
7 g	Fine sea salt
1 large	Egg, room temperature
1 large	Egg yolk, room temperature
42 g	Unsalted butter, softened
1 large	Egg, for the wash
a splash	Whole milk, for the wash
as needed	Melted or browned butter, to finish

METHOD

1. Tangzhong: whisk the milk, water and flour in a small pan, then cook over medium heat, whisking constantly, until it thickens to a paste. Scrape out and set aside.
2. Warm the milk to 95F, whisk in the yeast, leave 8 minutes somewhere warm.
3. Whisk the dry ingredients in the mixer bowl. With the hook on low, stream in the milk and yeast.
4. Add the tangzhong, the egg and the yolk. Mix on medium-low until even, scraping down as you go.
5. Add the butter a piece at a time, fully incorporating each before the next.
6. Knead 5 to 8 minutes more on medium-low until smooth.
7. Fold the edges to the centre, then roll seam-side down on the bench to a tight ball. Rise in a greased bowl under a damp towel, 1 to 1.5 hours, until doubled.
8. Punch down and divide into 6 pieces of 95 to 105 g.
9. Shape each: stretch and fold the edges in, flip seam-side down, then drag toward you against the board to build tension, rotating 90 degrees and repeating around the whole perimeter.
10. Space 6 cm apart on greased parchment. Cover with an inverted tray so they do not skin.
11. Rise 1 to 2 hours until doubled.
12. Heat the oven to 375F. Brush with the egg and milk wash.
13. Bake 16 to 18 minutes to a deep golden brown. Brush generously with melted butter straight out of the oven, then cool completely.

NOTES

A tangzhong plus an enriched dough, so it is part Japanese milk bread and part brioche. The cooked flour paste is what keeps them soft for days.
 Only 42 g butter to 320 g flour, far leaner than the maritozzo, because these carry a burger.
 Cover with an inverted tray rather than a cloth. A skin on the dough stops the rise.
 Buttering them hot is what gives the sheen.